

DANIEL SCHARF

Instructional Designer | Curriculum Development | Learning Program Management

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Portfolio: danielbscharf.github.io/Intercultural-Communication-Online-Web-Training

SUMMARY

Instructional designer and learning program manager with 10+ years of experience designing, delivering, and evaluating learning programs for adult and international learners in the U.S., Japan, and Sri Lanka. Applies needs and learner analysis, backward design, and measurable (SMART) learning objectives to build courses, training curricula, and assessments for in-person, online, and hybrid delivery. Track record of taking programs from concept to launch, training and coaching instructional staff, and partnering with stakeholders to improve learner outcomes. MA TESOL; builds interactive web-based learning with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

CORE SKILLS

Instructional Design: Needs & learner analysis, backward design, ADDIE, SMART learning objectives, scenario-based learning, assessment & rubric design, curriculum mapping, instructional materials development, eLearning development

Training & Facilitation: Train-the-trainer, instructor & tutor training, virtual and in-person facilitation, coaching & mentoring, intercultural communication training, adult learning

Program Management: Program lifecycle management, program evaluation & continuous improvement, data analysis & reporting, budgeting, staff supervision, stakeholder & cross-functional collaboration

Tools: Canvas, Brightspace (D2L), Moodle, Microsoft 365, Excel, Google Workspace, Zoom, Teams, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Bootstrap, GitHub, ChatGPT, Claude, NotebookLM, AI-assisted development (Codex)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Program Manager, International Language and Education Center Apr 2024 – Present

SUNY Oswego | Oswego, NY

- Led the end-to-end redesign and relaunch of a 3–6 week summer intensive English program, covering curriculum, assessment strategy, learner experience, recruitment, and a budget of up to \$50K; supervised 3 staff.
- Restructured the program curriculum into stackable micro-credentials integrating intercultural communication and professional skills.
- Designed and launched EASE, a new conditional admission pathway for students just below the English proficiency requirement, from needs analysis through support curriculum, exit criteria, and cross-department approval; first cohort enrolled Fall 2026.
- Design and revise credit-bearing English for Academic Purposes curricula, including learning outcomes, assessments, rubrics, and instructional materials, and guide them through institutional governance and approval.
- Designed and facilitated intercultural communication training workshops, later redesigned as a self-paced online course (see Portfolio).
- Analyze enrollment, assessment, and financial data to evaluate program performance and report recommendations to university leadership; collaborate with Admissions, International Student Services, advising, and faculty.

Faculty Development Workshop Facilitator (Remote) Apr 2021 – Feb 2022

AHEAD Operation | World Bank / Sri Lankan Ministry of Education

- Co-designed and facilitated 3 live online workshop series (6 sessions) for 50–100 university faculty per session, including a train-the-trainer program on developing academic literacy.
- Guided faculty in planning and launching campus tutoring centers, adapting content to differing institutional contexts and resources.
- Presented the initiative's outcomes at the International Writing Center Association Annual Conference (Vancouver, 2022).

Coordinator, Library Student Support Services Oct 2021 – Jun 2022

Southern Oregon University | Ashland, OR

- Supervised a team of about 17 tutors and help-desk staff, managing hiring, scheduling, training, budgeting, and performance support.
- Designed and delivered a tutor training curriculum to improve instructional quality and align services with student needs.
- Redesigned reservation and data-collection processes, then analyzed service data to inform program planning and decisions.
- Led cross-departmental collaboration to expand academic support services.

Global Teaching Fellow Mar 2016 – Sep 2021

Tokyo International University | Saitama, Japan

- Led an instructor team in designing the Analytical Reading and Thinking (ART) curriculum, adopted department-wide, using input from language and content faculty to identify learner needs.
- Co-founded and ran the Peer Advisers for Writing (PAW) program, building staff selection, onboarding, training, procedures, and ongoing development for a team of up to 8 peer tutors.
- Co-authored the PAW tutor-training handbook and program assessment materials, recognized with TESOL International's 2019 Mary Finocchiaro Award for Excellence in Unpublished Pedagogical Materials.
- Designed and taught courses in academic literacy, research skills, and critical thinking; used program data and stakeholder feedback to drive continuous improvement.

Additional Experience

- Part-Time Lecturer, Academic Literacy — Waseda University Academic Solutions, Tokyo (Oct 2023 – Feb 2024)
- Volunteer Website Coordinator — Online Writing Center Association (Jan 2023 – Dec 2024): maintained and restructured site content for an international professional organization.
- Business English Instructor — Freiburg, Germany (2008-2010): designed customized professional communication training for adult learners using presentations, simulations, and role-play.

INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGN PORTFOLIO

Intercultural Communication Workshop — self-paced online course | [View project](#)

- Redesigned an in-person, slide-based workshop into a 7-module self-paced web course using scenario-based learning, critical incidents, and a structured reflection framework (DAEA).
- Built interactive sorting, scenario-analysis, and guided-reflection activities with saved learner responses and progress tracking; documented the design rationale in a published case study.
- Developed with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript through an AI-assisted workflow, applying accessibility principles.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MA, TESOL — Portland State University

BA, History — Southern Oregon University

Certificate in Effective Teaching Practices — Association of College and University Educators (ACUE), 2026

Web Development Bootcamp — Le Wagon, Tokyo

Professional development: Instructional Design Essentials: Models of ID (LinkedIn Learning); TEFL Certificate; CRLA Master Level Tutor Certification